

How the Website Works

Saintly Beauty is a professional website built for a home-based hair business. It gives clients everything they need in one place, they can browse services, view a portfolio of past work, book appointments, and leave reviews.

What Was Built

- **Home page** - introduces the business with a portfolio preview and about section
- **Services page** - displays all hair services with pricing and duration, and loads related hair images automatically
- **Book Now page** - embedded Calendly booking tool so clients can schedule appointments directly
- **Portfolio page** - full showcase of hair work with photos and videos
- **Review page** - clients can submit, edit, and delete reviews which are saved to a database
- **Contact modal** - shows email, Instagram, and TikTok contact info from any page

Value Delivered

- Clients can book appointments online 24/7 without back-and-forth messaging
- Reviews build social proof and trust for new clients
- The portfolio showcases work professionally, replacing the need to send clients to social media
- The site is mobile-friendly and works on all screen sizes
- Performance was considered throughout. Images and videos load efficiently

Maintenance Plan

Booking appointments - managed entirely through Calendly. Log in at calendly.com to update availability, appointment types, and confirmation messages. No code changes needed.

Adding portfolio items - new images can be added to the `images/portfolio/` folder. Videos are pulled from YouTube so new videos just need their YouTube ID added to the `portfolioMedia` array in `portfolio.js`.

Viewing reviews - all submitted reviews are visible on the Leave a Review page. Reviews can be edited or deleted directly from that page.

Updating service info - service names, prices, and descriptions are stored in the database. These can be updated through phpMyAdmin on Hostgator.

Helpful resources:

- Calendly help center: help.calendly.com

- Hostgator phpMyAdmin guide: hostgator.com/help/article/mysql-phpmyadmin
- Unsplash API docs: unsplash.com/documentation

Code comments - all PHP and JavaScript files include comments explaining what each section does. Look for lines starting with `//` in JavaScript and `//` or `/* */` in PHP.

Key Lessons Learned

- Planning the database structure early saves significant time - knowing how tables relate to each other before writing any code makes everything cleaner
- PHP sessions and cookies are a simple but effective way to personalize a user's experience without requiring a login system
- Keeping reusable code in include files (like `db.php` and `validate.php`) makes updates much easier - change one file and it updates everywhere
- React and PHP serve different purposes - PHP is better for server-side data, React is better for interactive user interfaces
- Performance matters from the start - embedding too many videos at once caused browser slowdowns that required rethinking the approach

Suggested Future Improvements

- **User accounts** - allow clients to log in and manage their own reviews and bookings
- **Admin dashboard** - a private page to manage services, reviews, and view booking stats without needing phpMyAdmin
- **Email notifications** - send a confirmation email when a review is submitted
- **Instagram feed integration** - automatically pull recent posts into the portfolio instead of manually updating